Roles & Responsibilities

How management, field leadership and the pipe crew work together.

Direction down. Information up. Proof captured.

Information chain: PM > Super > Foreman > Topman > Pipelayer

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One package, different reading depth

Leaders should read the whole deck. Field crew need the quick read, role pages and handoff expectations.

Audience	Focus on	Expected takeaway
Pipelayer / Topman	Field quick read, crew roles, handoffs	Know what you own and what must move up.
Foreman	Entire deck	Own today, capture proof and connect crew to Super.
Superintendent	Entire deck	Own constraints, resources and next work.
PM / PC	Entire deck	Understand field needs and what records prove.

Labourers, TCPs and subs do not need every admin detail, but the leaders do.

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Field crew: safe work, clean install, clear handoff

Minimum operating standard for Topman, Pipelayer and supporting field roles.

Know today's task

What are we installing, where, to what grade and with what hazards?

Protect the workface

Utilities, trench access, bedding, pipe, public and equipment movements.

Speak up early

Wrong material, bad ground, water, missing survey or conflicting direction.

Pass information up

Quantities, delays, issues, packing slips, sub tickets and photos when asked.

The field does not need to become the office. The field needs to feed the office clean information.

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PM, Super and Foreman: read all of it

These roles connect contract, plan, production and proof. Conveniently, that is where chaos likes to camp.

PM

- Owns contract, client, budget and changes.
- Needs clean field records and early escalation.
- Turns field reality into commercial action.

Superintendent

- Owns sequence, resources and constraints.
- Needs accurate workface status from Foreman.
- Turns the contract plan into executable work.

Foreman

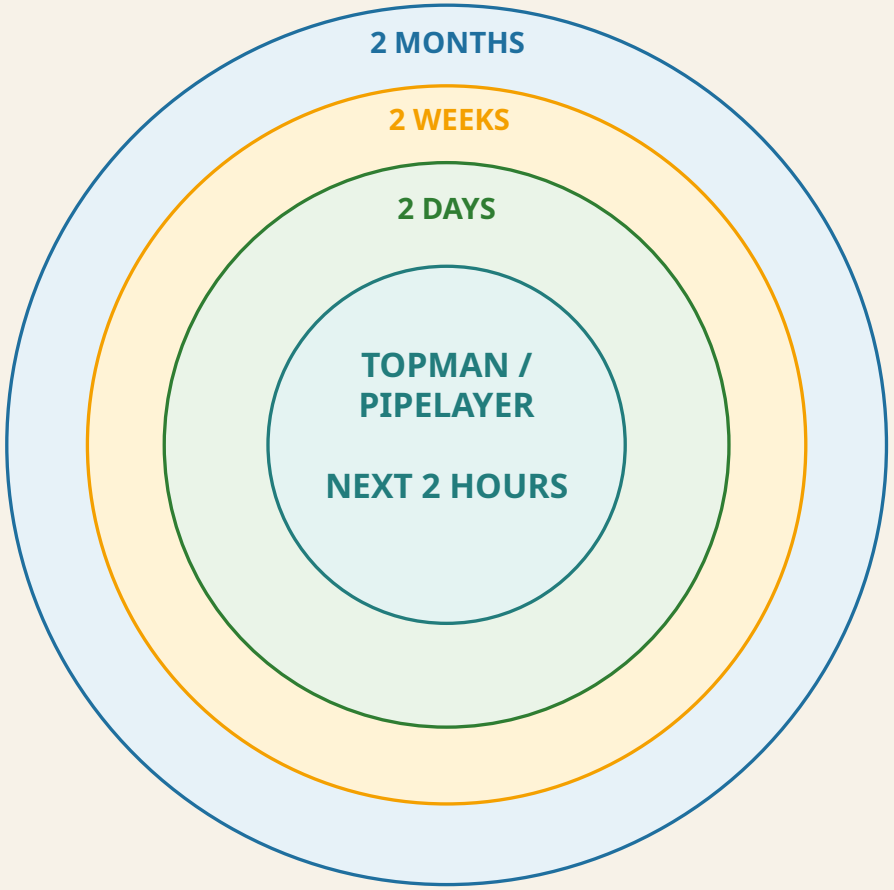
- Owns today's production and crew direction.
- Needs a clear plan, material and survey control.
- Turns work performed into records and proof.

Leadership roles own the interface between what was planned, what happened and what can be proven.

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Circle of responsibility

Illustrative planning horizon: each role looks ahead at a different scale.



Project Manager	**next 2 months**	Client, budget, risk, procurement and change position.
Superintendent	**next 2 weeks**	Sequence, access, equipment, material and constraints.
Foreman	**next 2 days**	Daily plan, crew readiness, tickets and tomorrow.
Topman / Pipelayer	**next 2 hours**	Immediate install, workface flow and what is about to stop production.

As responsibility moves outward, the planning window gets longer. That is the ideal model. Actual horizons vary by contractor, procurement needs, and organizational structure.

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The project loop

Direction moves down. Information moves up. Records protect the whole team.

PLAN

PM / Super set scope, sequence, budget and constraints.

>

SET UP

Super / Foreman line up labour, material, survey and equipment.

>

BUILD

Foreman, Topman and Pipelayer execute the work.

>

CAPTURE

Foreman collects quantities, tickets, slips and issues.

>

ACT

PM / PC use records for billing, changes and control.

If the loop breaks, the job starts relying on memory. Memory is not a cost control system.

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How the core team interfaces

The emphasis is clean handoff between roles, not corporate theatre with helmets.

Role	Primary focus	Key handoff
PM	Client, contract, change, budget and billing	Needs field proof and gives decisions back.
Superintendent	Sequence, resources, access and constraints	Gives executable plan and escalates impacts.
Foreman	Daily crew, workface, production and tickets	Gives quantities, issues and records.
Topman	Surface support, material flow and communication	Feeds the trench and Foreman.
Pipelayer	Install quality, line, grade and joints	Flags conflicts before they are buried.

The handoff is part of the work, not an optional courtesy for people with clipboards.

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Project Manager

Owns the commercial and contractual outcome.

OWNS

- Client relationship and formal communication.
- Contract, budget, billing and change management.
- Subcontracts, purchasing commitments and risk.
- Project-level reporting and commercial decisions.

NEEDS FROM OTHERS

- Early notice of changed conditions and delays.
- Daily quantities, labour and equipment usage.
- Signed tickets, packing slips and photos.
- Superintendent view on schedule and constraints.

GIVES BACK TO TEAM

- Commercial direction and client decisions.
- Approved changes and procurement support.
- Clear expectations for documentation and notices.
- Support when field issues become contract issues.

The PM protects the contract, but cannot do it without field proof.

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Superintendent

Owns the field plan and removes constraints.

OWNS

- Construction sequence, lookaheads and logistics.
- Labour, equipment and subcontractor coordination.
- Site access, material flow and upcoming constraints.
- Foreman support and resource alignment.

NEEDS FROM OTHERS

- Honest workface status from the Foreman.
- Crew productivity issues before they snowball.
- Survey, materials and subcontractor readiness.
- PM decisions on commercial or client issues.

GIVES BACK TO TEAM

- Executable plan for the Foreman.
- Clear priorities, safe sequencing and resource support.
- Escalation path for changed conditions.
- Lookahead needs for PM, PC and procurement.

The Super protects tomorrow so the Foreman can execute today.

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Foreman

Owns today's execution, crew direction and field proof.

OWNS

- Crew assignments and daily production.
- Workface safety, quality and equipment coordination.
- Quantities, labour, equipment and sub tickets.
- Escalating changes, delays and missing information.

NEEDS FROM OTHERS

- Clear plan, survey control and drawings.
- Material, equipment and subcontractor readiness.
- Support when the plan no longer fits site reality.
- PM / PC clarity on what must be documented.

GIVES BACK TO TEAM

- Daily quantities, issues and tomorrow's needs.
- Signed tickets, packing slips and photos.
- Early warning on bad ground, water or obstructions.
- Crew feedback on constructability.

The Foreman is the bridge between production and project control.

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Topman

Keeps the surface side organized so the trench keeps moving.

OWNS

- Material readiness at the workface.
- Communication between trench, operator and Foreman.
- Measurements, fittings, tools and surface support.
- Access and safe movement around the excavation.

NEEDS FROM OTHERS

- Clear direction from Foreman and Pipelayer.
- Survey control when needed.
- Correct pipe, fittings, bedding and tools.
- Safe access and coordinated equipment movements.

GIVES BACK TO TEAM

- Early warning on missing material or fittings.
- Actual quantities and field observations.
- Support to keep the Pipelayer productive.
- Surface conditions that affect install or safety.

The Topman protects flow. Poor surface support makes good trench work slow.

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Pipelayer

Owns the installed pipe quality inside the excavation.

OWNS

- Line, grade, joints, fittings and install quality.
- Checking pipe condition, bedding and constructability.
- Communicating conflicts before install continues.
- Supporting accurate completed quantities.

NEEDS FROM OTHERS

- Survey control, layout and correct material.
- Safe trench condition and equipment support.
- Topman support for pipe, tools and communication.
- Foreman direction on sequence and priorities.

GIVES BACK TO TEAM

- Installed quantity and install issues.
- Material mismatches, grade conflicts and obstructions.
- Constructability feedback from inside the trench.
- Quality concerns before they are covered.

The pipe does not care what the drawing intended. It only knows where it was installed.

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Supporting roles still affect the core team

Labourers, operators and TCPs directly affect production, even if they are not the focus here.

Role	How they support the core crew	What must be reported
Labourer	Compaction, pumps, barricades, cleanup, tools, hand work and spotting.	Unsafe conditions, missing tools, water or access issues.
Mainline operator	Excavation, lifting, trench shape, backfill placement and material handling.	Bad ground, obstructions, utility risk and equipment limits.
Loader operator	Spoil, aggregate, truck loading, material movement and site flow.	Material shortages, blocked access and truck delays.
Traffic controller	Public interface, vehicle flow, pedestrian control and safe equipment movement.	TCP conflicts, public risk and blocked routes.

Supporting roles either protect the workface or slow it down.

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Surveyors: the control interface

Survey is not just layout. It controls whether the crew can build with confidence.

Before work

- Confirm required layout and benchmarks.
- Identify missing control before the crew is waiting.
- Clarify staking, checking or as-built needs.

During work

- Respond to grade or alignment questions.
- Support tolerance-critical checks.
- Communicate changes to Foreman and Super.

After work

- Capture as-built data when required.
- Provide records to PC / PM.
- Flag discrepancies before cover or backfill.

Do not wait until pipe is in the ground to discover nobody owned the layout question.

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External resources must plug into our system

Subs, rentals and suppliers support production. Their records must support payment and change management.

Resource	Required from them	Who checks first
Subcontracted labour / equipment	Ticket with date, location, scope, hours, equipment ID and standby reason.	Foreman
Trucking / disposal	Ticket, material type, load count or weight, disposal location and times.	Foreman / Loader
Material supplier	Packing slip with quantity, material, PO reference and delivery location.	Receiver / Foreman
Specialty subcontractor	Daily work record, install or test docs, photos and signed ticket.	Foreman / Super
Surveyor	Layout, check shots, as-built data or field notes tied to area and date.	Super / Foreman

If we cannot verify it, we cannot confidently pay it, bill it or defend it.

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Tickets, timesheets and packing slips

Field activity becomes usable project information only when the record is clean. Tragic, but true.

Must show

- Project and location.
- Date, start and finish times.
- Actual task or material.
- Quantity, equipment or employee names.
- Foreman review or signature where required.

Do not accept

- Wrong project or vague description.
- Standby time with no reason.
- Unsigned or unreadable ticket.
- Missing disposal or material quantity.
- Paperwork leaving site with no copy.

Send to office

- Photo or scan the same day.
- Tie to job, phase or cost code.
- Flag changes or unusual costs.
- Keep original if required.
- Confirm gaps before invoices arrive.

The best time to fix bad paperwork is before the truck, sub or supplier leaves.

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Changed condition: what happens next

Water, bad soil, obstruction, utility conflict or drawing issue appears during the work.

Role	Immediate responsibility
Pipelayer / Topman	Identify the issue, protect the work and tell the Foreman before continuing blindly.
Foreman	Stabilize the situation, take photos, record time/location and notify the Super.
Superintendent	Assess options, revise sequence, confirm resources and escalate impacts to PM.
PM	Review commercial impact, notify client if needed and manage change position.
PC / Support	Organize photos, tickets, daily notes, drawings, RFIs and backup.

Changed conditions are safety, schedule, cost and contract problems.

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The daily handoff keeps the job moving

A clean day starts with a clear plan and ends with usable records.

Before work

- Scope and sequence understood.
- Survey control and drawings checked.
- Material, equipment and subs confirmed.
- Traffic and public interface understood.

During work

- Crew executes plan safely.
- Issues are raised early.
- Sub tickets and deliveries are controlled.
- Quantities are tracked while fresh.

After work

- Quantities and delays reported.
- Tickets, slips and photos submitted.
- Tomorrow's needs identified.
- Super / PM notified of impacts.

A job that reports clearly can adjust quickly. A job that hides information gets surprised loudly.

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The standard: clear ownership, clean handoffs

The goal is not more paperwork. The goal is fewer surprises and better control.

PM	Super	Foreman	Topman	Pipelayer
Protects contract and money	Protects the plan	Protects today's production	Protects workface flow	Protects install quality

Everyone owns their role. Everyone feeds the project.

That is how the crew and management work together without turning every problem into a treasure hunt.

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